

Literature Review

A **literature review** is an organized and critical study of previous research and published information related to a particular topic.

It helps the researcher understand **what has already been studied, what results were found, and what still needs to be studied.**

Purposes of Literature Review

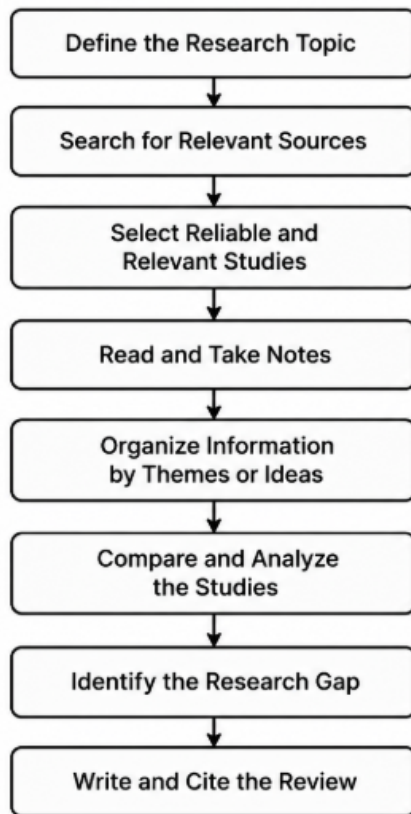
The main purposes are:

1. To understand the research topic
2. To identify important theories and concepts
3. To know previous research findings
4. To compare previous studies and avoid duplication
5. To identify research gaps

Sources of Literature

Source	Simple Meaning
Research Journals	Published research papers written by researchers.
Books & Textbooks	Books that provide basic and detailed information.
Conference Papers	Research papers presented at academic conferences.
Theses & Dissertations	Detailed research work done by students and researchers.
Government Reports	Reports and information published by government organizations.
Institutional Reports	Reports prepared by universities, organizations and research institutions.
Academic Websites and Databases	Reliable online sources containing research information.

Steps in Conducting a Literature Review



1. Define the Research Topic: Clearly identify the topic or problem to be studied.

2. Search for Relevant Sources: Search for books, journals, research papers and other reliable sources related to the topic.

3. Select Reliable Studies: Choose sources that are relevant, reliable and useful for the project.

4. Read and Take Notes: Read the selected sources and note down important ideas, methods and findings.

5. Organize the Information: Arrange the information based on common themes, ideas, methods or findings.

6. Compare and Analyze the Studies: Compare different studies and identify their similarities, differences, strengths and limitations.

7. Identify the Research Gap: Find areas that are not studied properly or questions that are still unanswered.

8. Write and Cite the Review: Write the findings in a clear order and give proper references to the original sources.

How to Write a Good Literature Review

A good literature review should be written in the following way:

1. Start with the **general background** of the topic.
2. Explain the **important theories and concepts**.
3. Group previous studies based on **themes, methods or findings**.
4. Compare the results of different studies.
5. Mention important **strengths and limitations** of previous studies.
6. Identify the **research gap**.
7. Explain how the present project will address the gap.
8. Give **proper citations and references** for all sources.

Example

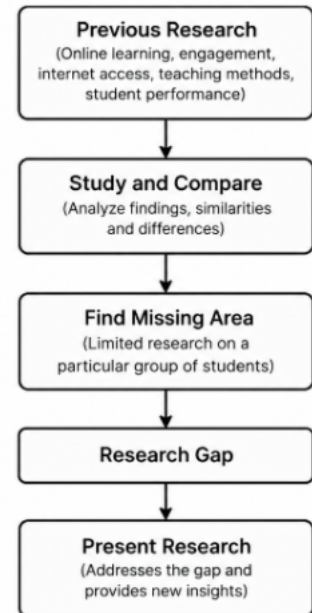
Topic: Online Learning and Student Performance

Suppose a researcher wants to study the effect of **online learning on student performance**.

The researcher may study previous research about:

- Online learning
- Student engagement
- Internet access
- Teaching methods
- Student performance

After studying and comparing these researches, the researcher may find that **there is limited research about online learning among a particular group of students**. This missing area is called a **research gap**.



Bibliography

A **bibliography** is a list of books, research papers, articles, websites and other sources used or consulted while preparing a project, assignment or research report.

It is usually given at the **end of the project report**. It helps the reader identify and find the sources used by the researcher.

Purpose of a Bibliography

The main purposes are:

1. **To acknowledge the sources**
2. **To give credit to author**
3. **To help readers find sources**
4. **To show the research work done**
5. **To improve the credibility of the report**
6. **To avoid plagiarism.**

Information Included in a Bibliography

A bibliography normally contains the following information:

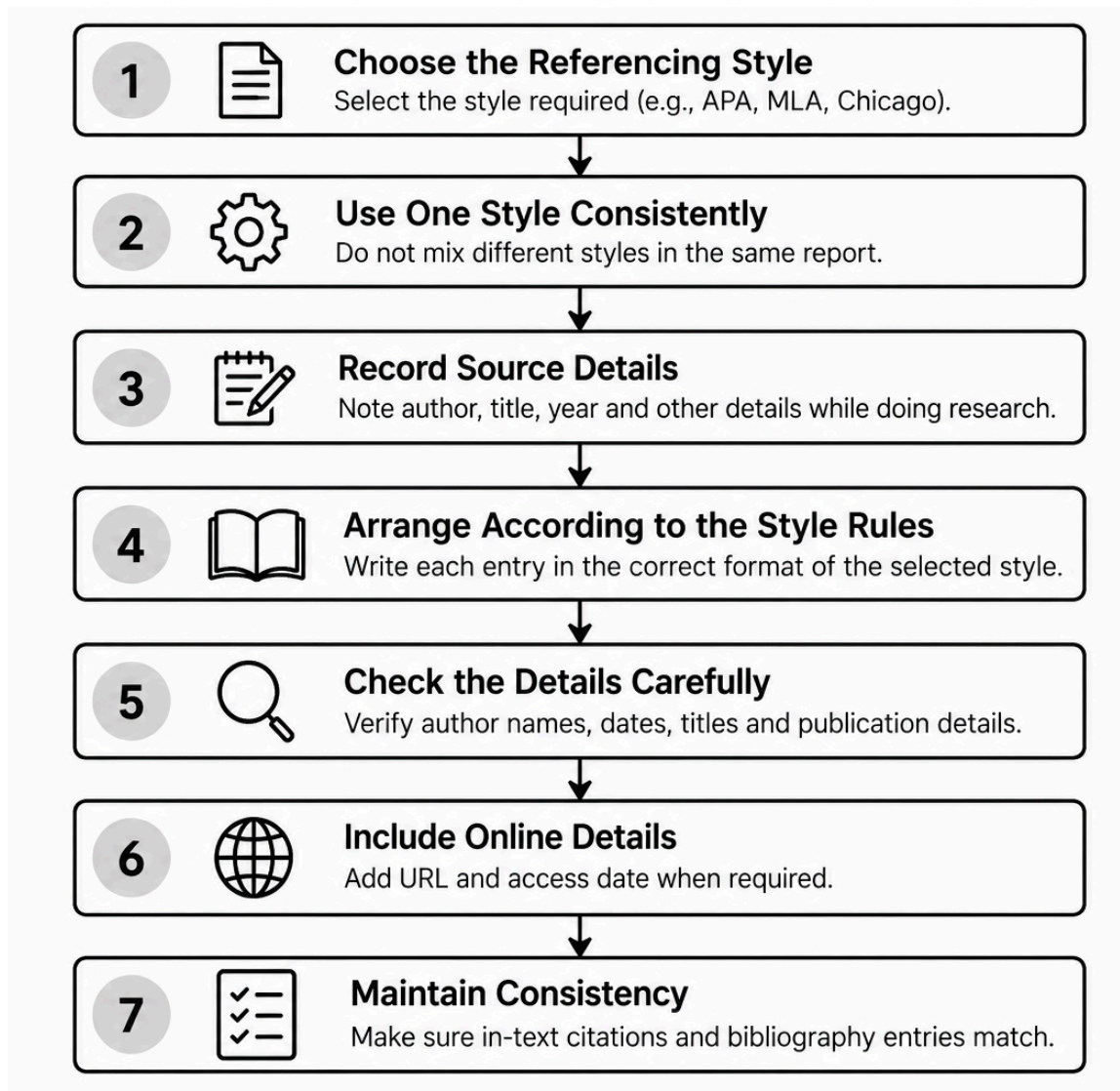
Information	Meaning
Author's Name	Name of the person who wrote the source.
Title	Name of the book, article or webpage.
Publisher / Journal	Name of the publisher or journal.
Year of Publication	Year in which the source was published.
Edition / Volume / Issue	Additional publication details when required.
Page Numbers	Pages used from a book or journal article, when applicable.
URL	Web address for an online source, when required.
Access Date	Date on which an online source was accessed, when required.

Common Referencing Styles

Different styles are used to prepare bibliographic entries.

Style	Common Use	Basic Pattern
APA	Education, Psychology and Social Sciences	Author. (Year). <i>Title</i> . Publisher.
MLA	Humanities and Literature	Author. <i>Title</i> . Publisher, Year.
Chicago	History and many other subjects	Author. <i>Title</i> . Publication details.

Rules for Preparing a Bibliography



Examples of Bibliography

Book – APA Style

Sharma, R. (2023). *Research methodology*.
ABC Publishers.

Journal Article – APA Style

Kumar, A., & Rao, S. (2024). Online learning and student performance. *Journal of Educational Studies*, 10(2), 25–35.

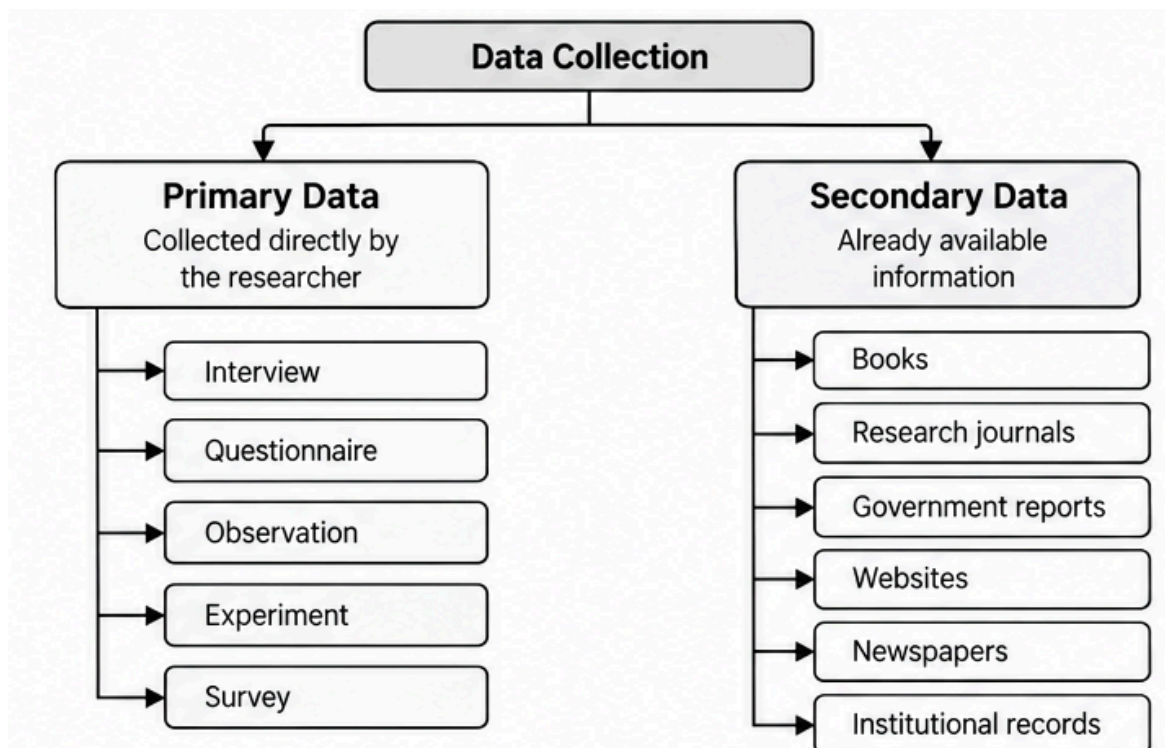
Methods of Data Collection and Tools & Procedures

Data collection is the process of collecting information needed for a research project.

The researcher uses different **methods, tools and procedures** to collect accurate and useful data.

- **Methods** tell us **how data is collected**.
- **Tools** are the instruments used to collect the data.
- **Procedures** explain the **steps followed during data collection**.

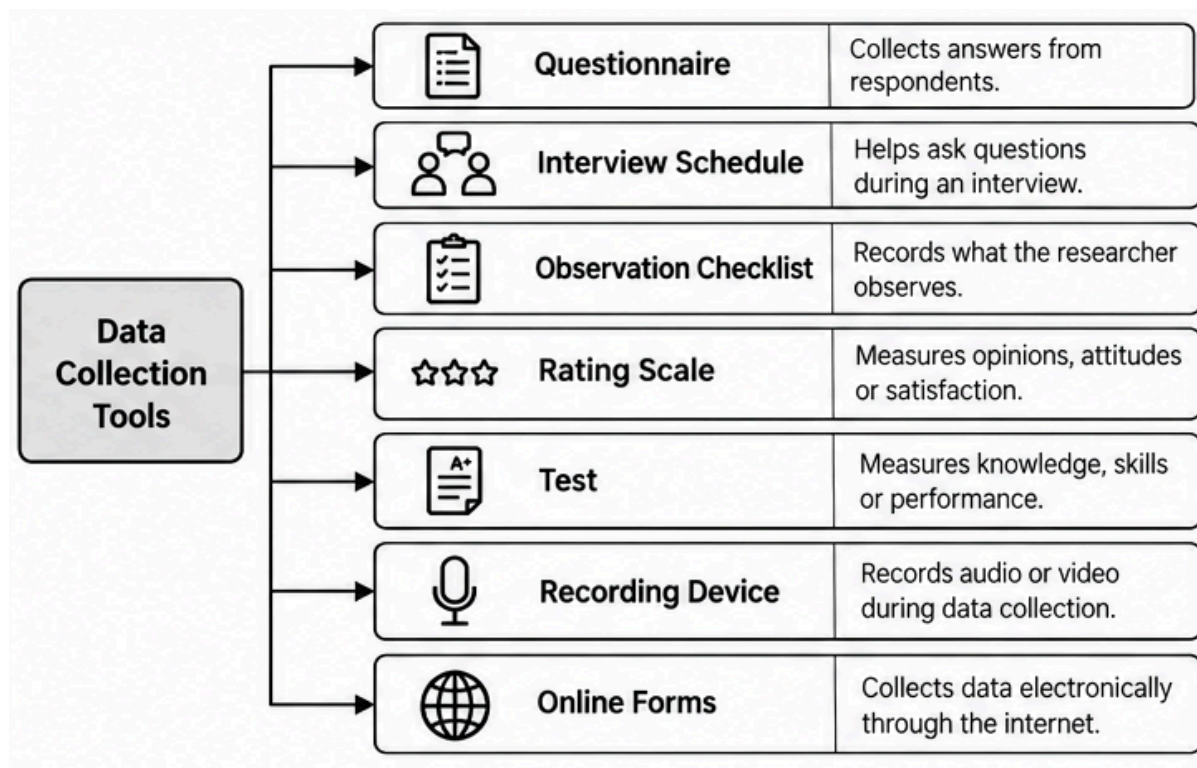
2. Methods of Data Collection



Point	Primary Data	Secondary Data
Meaning	Data collected directly by the researcher.	Data already collected by others.
Source	People, surveys, interviews, experiments.	Books, journals, reports, websites.
Purpose	Collected for the current project.	Collected earlier for another purpose.
Time	Takes more time to collect.	Takes less time to collect.
Cost	Usually it costs more.	Usually it costs less.
Example	Questionnaire from students.	Government education report.

3. Tools for Data Collection

A **data collection tool** is an instrument used by the researcher to collect and record information.



Procedures for Data Collection



Selection of Suitable Method and Tool

The researcher should select the method and tool based on:

1. **Research objective**
2. **Type of information required**
3. **Number of participants**
4. **Available time**
5. **Available budget**
6. **Nature of the research topic**
7. **Accuracy required**
8. **Availability of participants**

Qualities of a Good Data Collection Tool

A good data collection tool should be:

- **Simple** – Easy for participants to understand.
 - **Clear** – Questions should have clear meaning.
 - **Relevant** – Questions should be related to the research topic.
 - **Reliable** – Should provide consistent results.
 - **Valid** – Should measure what it is intended to measure.
 - **Unbiased** – Should not influence the participant's answer.
 - **Easy to use** – Should be convenient for both researchers and participants.
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Example

